



STACK × INDIA

MADE FOR BHARAT.

पढ़ो। सहेजो। याद रखो।

How Stack can speak India's languages, fit its study habits and look like it belongs here.

01
Why it matters

02
Language first

03
How India studies

04
Look and feel

05
Reach and price

06
What to avoid ·
order of work



WHY IT MATTERS

Stack was built in English, for readers of English tech news. Most Indians read, listen and study in more than one language. The app that respects that has far more people it can serve.

98%

of India's internet users went online in an Indian language in 2024. That is about 870 million people

IAMAI-Kantar, Internet in India 2024

57%

of urban internet users say they prefer content in an Indian language

IAMAI-Kantar, 2024

140M

people use voice commands online. More than half of them live in rural India

IAMAI-Kantar, 2024

22

Indian languages are covered by Sarvam's speech and translation models, and by the government's Bhashini

docs.sarvam.ai · Bhashini

STACK TODAY, SEEN FROM INDIA

PART	TODAY	WHAT I FOUND IN THE APP
Indian news sources	Good	The Hindu, Times of India, Indian Express, Mint, NDTV, WION and India Today, with an India topic. All in English
How Indians share files	Good	Share to Stack works from WhatsApp, and "Import from Telegram" brings in forwarded PDFs
Weak networks	Good	Offline reading, local-first storage, and it works without an account
Listening in Hindi	Partly	Listen mode already picks a Hindi voice for Devanagari text, if the phone has one
App language	English only	Every button and message is in English, and the app tells Android it is an English app
Indian-language news	None built in	A reader can add a Hindi feed by hand under "My feeds", but nothing is offered
AI in Indian languages	Not yet	Stack AI is not live, and Sarvam is not in the code (see Stack_AI_and_Sarvam_AI.pdf)
Indian time	UTC	The AI limit resets at 5:30 AM IST, because the day is counted in UTC
Look and identity	Neutral	A clean international design. Nothing in it says where Stack is from

THE IDEA IN ONE LINE

Read in any language, think in your own. A student saves an English article or a coaching PDF, reads the points in Hindi, speaks a note in Hinglish, and revises it next morning. No big English-first reading app does this well, and that is Stack's opening.



LANGUAGE FIRST

Language is the largest single change. Do it in this order, because each step makes the next one worth more.

- 1

The app itself in Hindi

CODE · ABOUT A WEEK

Move every button and message into one text file per language, then add Hindi. The app follows the phone's language, with a choice in Settings. Keep words people already use in English: PDF, note, highlight, playlist.
- 2

AI answers in the reader's language

CODE · 1 TO 2 DAYS

One "AI language" setting. Summaries, "Explain simply" and Ask your Stack then answer in that language, whatever language the article is in. This is Sarvam's main strength.
- 3

News in Indian languages

CODE · 2 TO 3 DAYS

Offer ready feed packs at first launch: Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi. "My feeds" already reads any RSS feed, so this is a list of feeds, not new machinery. Check that each publisher offers a public feed and allows it.
- 4

Type that suits Indian scripts

CODE · 1 DAY

Archivo has no Devanagari or Tamil letters, so the phone swaps in its own font. Choose one on purpose. **Anek** is an open-source family for ten Indian scripts and has the same wide-to-narrow range as Archivo. Indian scripts need more line height and no negative letter spacing.
- 5

Hinglish is normal

CODE · 2 TO 3 DAYS

People type Hindi in English letters. Tidy must keep it as it is, and search should find "ज्ञान" when someone types "gyaan". Sarvam's speech model has modes for mixed and romanised speech.
- 6

Voice in, voice out

CODE · ABOUT A WEEK

Speak a note or a question; hear the summary in an Indian voice. Costs are in Stack_AI_and_Sarvam_AI.pdf, page 4.

WHICH LANGUAGES, IN WHAT ORDER

WAVE	LANGUAGES	WHY
1	Hindi and Hinglish	The largest group, and the one you can check yourself
2	Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi	Large reading and exam audiences. IMAI-Kantar names Tamil and Telugu among the most used Indian languages online
3	Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia, Punjabi	The rest of the ten languages Sarvam's chat model supports

ONE RULE

Never ship a language nobody has checked. A machine translation of the app's buttons reads as careless, and that does more harm than staying in English. For each language, find one reader among your testers who goes through every screen.



HOW INDIA STUDIES

Culture is habits as well as language. Indian students already have strong reading and revision habits. Stack should fit into them instead of asking for new ones.

FITS WHAT IS BUILT

PDFs arrive on Telegram and WhatsApp

Coaching notes, question papers and newspaper PDFs move through Telegram channels and WhatsApp groups. Stack already imports from both. Put this at the front of the first-run screens: "Forward your study PDFs to Stack".

SMALL JOB

Exam shelves

Ready shelf sets for UPSC, SSC, banking, JEE, NEET, CUET, CA and state exams, with the right subjects as shelves. The reader picks an exam at first launch, as they pick interests today.

SMALL JOB

An exam date and a countdown

Enter the exam date once. Today shows the days left, and the daily review brings back more highlights as the date gets closer.

MEDIUM JOB

Current affairs as a daily habit

Many aspirants read an editorial every morning and make notes. A "Today's editorial" card, highlight, then the morning review and the quiz from highlights turn that into one flow.

SMALL JOB

Revision words people use

In the Hindi version call the daily review रिवीज़न and the focus session अभ्यास (practice). Keep "Pomodoro" as a timer choice. Test the words with readers before fixing them.

MEDIUM JOB

School books, the legal way

NCERT textbooks are free to download from NCERT's own site. Link to them from a "Textbooks" shelf so the reader downloads them into Stack. Do not put the files inside the app.

LATER · STACK FOR TEAMS

The coaching batch

A teacher shares PDFs to a batch, students highlight and get quizzed, and the teacher sees progress. This is the Teams plan in the business plan, and coaching centres are its natural first buyers.

SMALL JOB

Study together

Share a highlight as a picture card to WhatsApp, with the source and the Stack mark. Students already send each other notes; this makes each share bring a new reader.

WHO THIS POINTS TO

The business plan picked "students, developers and self-learners in India who save articles and PDFs and forget them".

Exam aspirants are the part of that group with the strongest daily habit and the clearest reason to revise. **Pick one exam for the soft launch and make Stack right for it, then widen.**



LOOK & FEEL

Identity should be felt, not shouted. Keep Stack's clean paper-and-ink design and add a few things that an Indian reader recognises as their own.

BRAND

The line, in two languages

"Read it. Keep it. Build on it." next to पढ़ो। सहेजो। याद रखो। on the splash, the store listing and the website. One short line per language, checked by a native reader.

BRAND

Patterns from the Stack blocks

The logo is four stacked blocks. Use the same blocks to draw kolam and rangoli style dot patterns for empty screens, streak cards and share cards. It stays Stack's own shape and reads as Indian.

EVERYDAY

Indian time, dates and numbers

Count the day in IST so limits and streaks turn over at midnight in India. Show dates as 1 Oct 2026, and numbers in lakh and crore: ₹1,00,000, not ₹100,000.

EVERYDAY

A calendar that knows India

A quiet card on festival days, and a "do not break my streak" pause for them. Add exam seasons: board exams early in the year, entrance exams after. Cover festivals of all communities, and let people switch the cards off.

CONTENT

A starter shelf of Indian classics

A few public-domain works offered at first launch in old translations whose copyright has ended, for example the Thirukkural and the Arthashastra. Readers start with something on the shelf. Check each edition's copyright.

CONTENT

Badges with Indian names

Stack has 12 badges. Name some after ideas people know, for example अभ्यास for a 7-day streak and एकाग्र for a full focus session. Avoid the names of gods and religious figures.

SOUND

Focus sound that suits study

Offer simple study sounds made for Stack or released free to use, such as a tanpura drone or rain. Do not bundle film songs: they are copyrighted. The reader's own music stays as it is.

STORY

Say where it is from

"Made in India by StackForge Labs. Open source. Works without an account." This is already true, and trust matters when 28 lakh cyber-fraud cases are reported in a year.

A CAUTION ON COLOURS AND SYMBOLS

Stack's green and orange already sit close to the national colours. Do not arrange them as the flag, and do not use the national flag or emblem in the icon or the logo: Indian law restricts their use by businesses. Patterns, language and names carry identity safely.



REACH & PRICE

Being Indian in practice means working on the phones, networks and budgets that people have.

AREA	WHAT TO DO	WHY
Phones	Test on a phone with 3 to 4 GB of memory. Keep the download small: the debug APK is about 15 MB today	Many students use low-cost Android phones with little free storage
Network	Add a "light mode" that skips images and video on mobile data. Offline reading is already built	Data is cheap in India but coverage is patchy
Price	Keep ₹99 a month, ₹799 a year and ₹499 a year for students, as in the business plan	Readwise costs \$9.99 a month, which is too much for most Indian students
Paying	Use Google Play Billing, where people in India can pay with UPI. Offer the yearly plan first	Many students have no card
Store listing	Add a Hindi listing, then one per language as it ships	Play shows a translated listing to phones set to that language
Privacy	Keep the consent screen before AI, the export, and delete-account. Translate them too	The DPDP Act's full rules apply from 13 May 2027

WHERE TO FIND PEOPLE

STUDY GROUPS

Telegram and WhatsApp

Exam groups already pass PDFs around. Offer a short guide: "Forward this PDF to Stack and revise it tomorrow". Follow each group's rules about promotion.

CAMPUSES

Student ambassadors

One student per college or coaching centre, with free Stack Plus and a referral link. Start with your own college and two more.

CREATORS

Teachers who post in Hindi

Small study channels in Indian languages reach the right people. Give them the app and ask for an honest look, not a paid review.

TWO ENGINES FOR INDIAN LANGUAGES

PAID · FAST TO START

Sarvam AI

Chat in 10 Indian languages, speech and translation in 22. ₹100 free credit, then pay as you go. This is the engine planned for Stack AI.

GOVERNMENT · LISTED AS FREE

Bhashini

India's public language platform offers translation, speech to text and text to speech for 22 languages, and is described as free for developers. It is worth testing as a backup for translation and reading aloud. I did not check its sign-up terms, limits or quality.



DO IT WELL

AVOID	WHY IT HURTS	DO THIS INSTEAD
Unchecked translations	Wrong or stiff Hindi looks careless	One native reader checks every screen before a language ships
Religion and politics in the brand	India is many communities; taking a side loses the rest	Stay neutral. Celebrate every community's festivals or none
Stereotypes as decoration	Elephants, turbans and "namaste" everywhere read as a tourist's India	Language, habits and small patterns
The national flag or emblem in the logo	Their use by businesses is restricted by law	Stack's own blocks and colours
Bundling books, songs or coaching PDFs	Copyright complaints and Play removals	Link to the legal source; bundle only public-domain works
Showing whole news articles from publishers	The same copyright risk, in every language	Headline, summary and a link; full reader only for what the reader saved
Ten languages at once	Ten half-finished versions and nobody to check them	Hindi first, then one wave at a time
Trusting AI in every language equally	Quality differs by language, and a wrong summary costs trust	Test 20 real articles per language and keep the report button

ORDER OF WORK

LARGEST EFFECT FOR THE LEAST WORK FIRST. EFFORT IS MY ESTIMATE

#	CHANGE	EFFORT	EFFECT	WHEN
1	Count the day in IST for limits and streaks	An hour	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Before the soft launch
2	AI answers in the reader's language (Sarvam)	1 to 2 days	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Before the soft launch
3	Hindi store listing and the two-language line	A day	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Before the soft launch
4	Exam shelves and "forward your PDFs" at first launch	2 to 3 days	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	During the soft launch
5	The app in Hindi, with a chosen Indian-script font	About a week	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	During the soft launch
6	Indian-language feed packs	2 to 3 days	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	During the soft launch
7	Voice notes and the Indian voice for summaries	About a week	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Before the public launch
8	Patterns, badges, festival and exam calendar	About a week	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Before the public launch
9	Second wave of languages; scanned PDFs to text	2 to 3 weeks	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	After the public launch

Sources. IAMAI-Kantar, Internet in India 2024 (iamai.in; reported by medianama.com and ibef.org) · Sarvam models and prices (docs.sarvam.ai, sarvam.ai/api-pricing, read 01.10.2026) · Bhashini, as described by third-party guides (schemesinindia.in, aistartupimpact.com) · StackForge_Stack_Plan.pdf for pricing, the DPDP date and the cyber-fraud figure · Stack's own code for "Stack today". **Not checked:** each publisher's feed terms, each classic's copyright status, Bhashini's terms, and the exact legal limits on national symbols. Get advice before relying on those.